

SHADOW AI

I Found Shadow AI Running On My Own Team

Two months in, and my first instinct to shut it down was the wrong one.

UNROLL THE DRAWING

SECTION 02 · THE TIMELINE

How Long It Ran Before I Noticed

A contractor started using it in June. I found it by accident in a billing reconciliation.

FIG. 2



SCALE · PRODUCTION

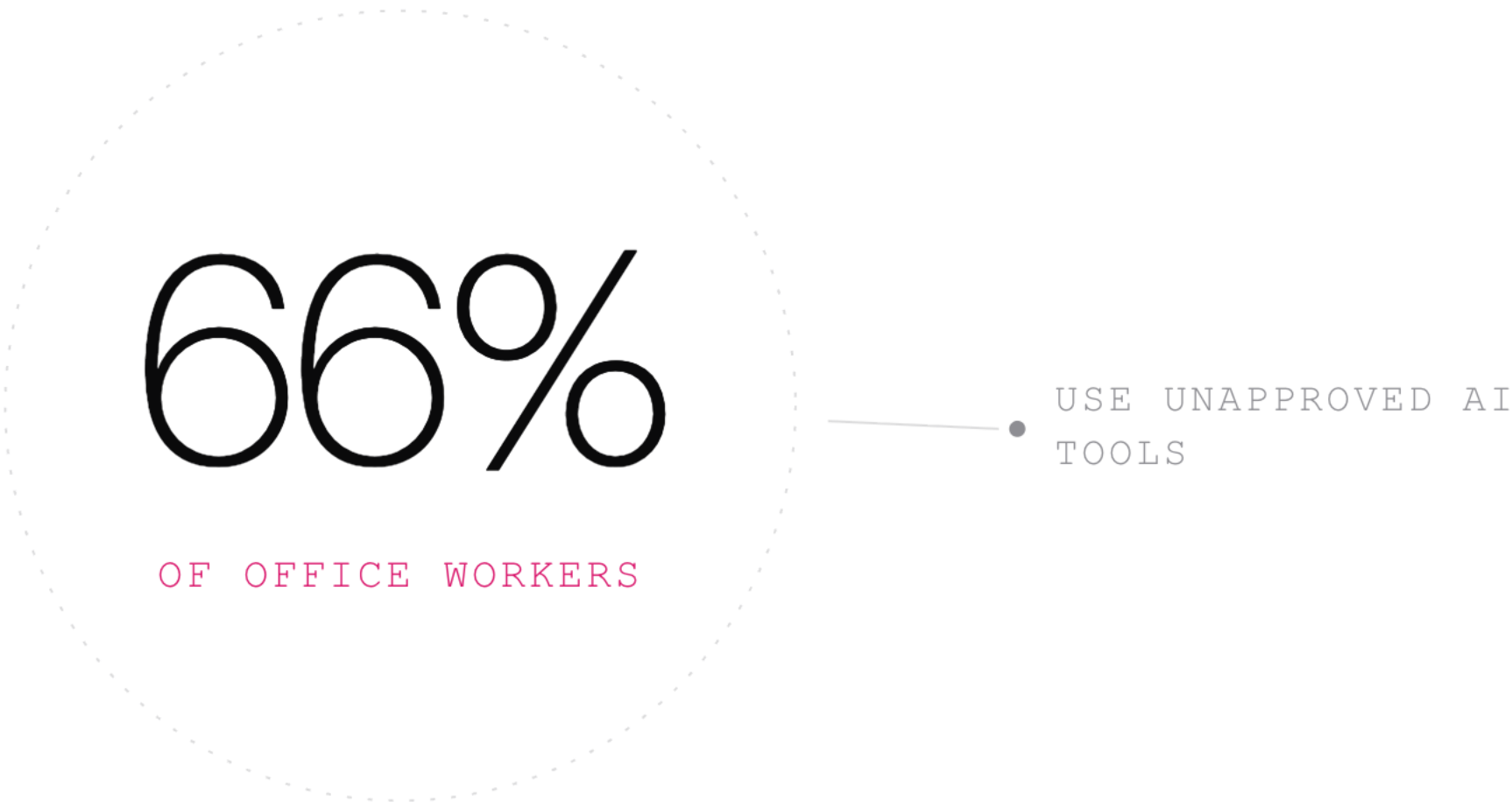
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SECTION 03 · PAGERDUTY 2026

This Isn't Rare. It's Most Of Your Team

66% of office professionals have used an AI tool at work they believed wasn't approved.

FIG. 3



SCALE · PRODUCTION

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SECTION 04 · INSTINCT VS. ACTION

My First Instinct Was The Wrong Call

Shutting it down would have fixed the optics and broken a workflow that was actually working.

FIG. 4

FIRST INSTINCT

- SHUT IT DOWN
- LOCK THE TOOL

VS

WHAT I DID

- NAMED THE USE CASE
- WROTE ONE POLICY

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SECTION 05 · THE POLICY

The One Page Policy I Wrote Instead

Declare the tool, name an owner, set a data boundary, review it every quarter.

FIG. 5



DECLARE THE TOOL

PASS



NAME AN OWNER

PASS



SET DATA BOUNDARY

PASS

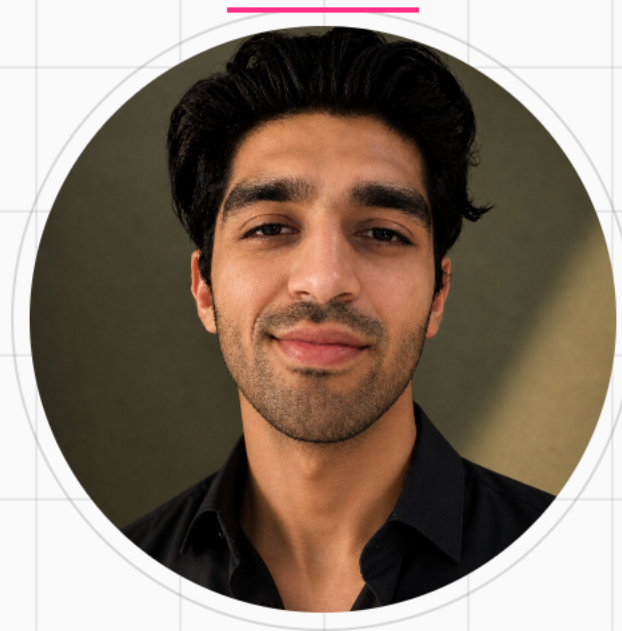


REVIEW QUARTERLY

LIVE

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Find Out What's Running Before It Finds You

The next one is already there. You just haven't found it yet.

FOLLOW THE POLICY